

EVIDENCE LOG

For Radiculopathy (Sciatica/Nerve Pain) VA Disability Claims

THE SMOKING GUN EVIDENCE

After years of navigating the VA claims process—as veterans ourselves—we discovered something that changes everything: **the single most powerful piece of evidence you can submit isn't officially part of a Fully Developed Claim.**

"No more convincing. Just corroboration."

When you walk into a C&P exam without this documentation, the examiner's job is to **investigate whether your condition exists and how severe it is.** They're playing detective. You're trying to convince them.

When you walk in WITH a properly completed Evidence Log, the dynamic completely shifts. The examiner's job becomes **corroborating what you've already documented.** They're not investigating—they're verifying. That's a fundamentally different exam.

HOW VA RATERS ACTUALLY EVALUATE YOUR CLAIM

Every VA disability rating—regardless of condition—is based on three core factors. Raters are trained to look for evidence of these specific elements:

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT RATERS LOOK FOR
FREQUENCY	How often do your symptoms occur?	Daily? Weekly? Constant? with specific triggers?
SEVERITY	How intense are your symptoms when they occur?	Pain levels (1-10)? Range of Motion loss? Duration?
FUNCTIONAL IMPACT	How do symptoms affect your daily life?	Can't work? Can't sleep? Can't lift kids? Missed events?

Why This Evidence Log Works: The template you're about to use is specifically designed to capture all three factors in a format that's easy for raters to process. When a rater opens your file and sees 30 days of documented symptoms with frequency, severity, and functional impact clearly recorded, they don't have to guess or interpret. The evidence speaks for itself.

DO NOT FILE ANY CLAIM UNTIL THIS LOG IS COMPLETED AND INCLUDED WITH YOUR SUBMISSION

RADICULOPATHY: CONDITION-SPECIFIC GUIDANCE

Radiculopathy is nerve pain caused by compression in the spine. It is often **secondary** to back or neck conditions.

- **Sciatica:** Lower back down the leg.
- **Cervical:** Neck down the arm.

What to Log:

- **Sensation:** Numbness, tingling, "pins and needles," burning.
- **Weakness:** Foot drop? Dropping items? Trouble gripping?
- **Trigger:** Sneezing, sitting too long?

Rating Criteria:

RATING	SEVERITY
10%	Mild: Subjective symptoms, minor sensation loss.
20%	Moderate: Some weakness, absent reflexes, distinct sensation loss.
40%	Severe: Marked weakness, muscle atrophy.

COMPLETED EXAMPLE: 7-DAY EVIDENCE LOG

Below is an example of a properly completed Evidence Log.

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Mon 1/6	1400	Burning pain shooting down left leg to toes. 8/10.	Had to stand up during meeting. Could not sit >15 mins.

Tue 1/7	0900	Numbness in right foot. Tripped on carpet.	"Foot drop" sensation. Afraid to carry baby.
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YOUR EVIDENCE LOG: 30-DAY TEMPLATE

Instructions: Complete one row per day for at least 30 consecutive days.

VETERAN NAME: _____ **CLAIM #:** _____
CONDITION: Radiculopathy (Sciatica/Nerve Pain) (DC 8520/8620) **START DATE:** _____

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
...			
Day 30			

Note: Print this page multiple times to cover 30 days.